In the first phase of planning, the Planning Commission estimates the physical, capital and human resources available in the country. In the second phase, the federal and state governments make their own plans and send them to the Planning Commission, after studying which the commission integrates the plans sent by different governments. At the beginning of the third phase, the Planning Commission issues the draft plan. After that, after determining the nature of the projects from various governments, the Planning Commission, after consulting the Union Cabinet and various ministries, presents the final form of the plan to the cabinet. After the approval of the cabinet, the draft plan is sent to the National Development Council (NDC). The NDC gives final approval to the plan proposed by the Planning Commission. After this the plan is presented in the Parliament, where after approval it becomes 'Government Plan' and it is published.

22. Who finally approves the draft of five year plans?

(a) President
(b) Planning Commission
(c) National Development Council
(d) None of the above

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

See the above question's explanation.

23. The Mahalanobis heavy industry development plan was opposed by wage-goods development plan, whose main author was

(a) Prof. R. N. Dandekar (b) Prof. Madhu Dandavate
(c) Prof. Brahmananda (d) Prof. Amartya Sen
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Project Manager Prelims 2021

Ans. (c)

The author of the wage-goods development plan opposed to the Mahalanobis heavy industry development plan was a team consisting of Professor C.N. Vakil and Professor P.R. Brahmananda. Their wage-goods model focused on the importance of satisfying immediate basic needs and increasing worker productivity through the consumption of wage goods, which include food, clothing and other necessities.

24. The Sarvodaya Plan was proposed by

(a) Vinoba Bhave (b) M. G. Gandhi
(c) Ram Manohar Lohia (d) Jayaprakash Narayan
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Project Manager Prelims 2021

Ans. (d)

The Sarvodaya Plan was proposed by Jaya Prakash Narayan published in January, 1950. Major idea of the plan were highly similar to the Gandhian plan like emphasis on agriculture, agri-based small and cottage industries, self reliance and almost no dependence on foreign capital and technology, land reforms, self dependent villages etc.

Money and Banking

1. When the supply for money increases and the demand for money reduces, there will be

(a) a decrease in the rate of interest
(b) a fall in the level of prices
(c) a fall in the level of demand
(d) an increase in the rate of interest
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (a)

When the supply of money increases and the demand for money reduces, it typically leads to situation where there is more money available in the economy than there is demand for it. In such a scenario, several outcomes are possible-
- Lower interest rate
- Increase Investment and Consumption
- Potential for Inflation
- Currency Depreciation

2. Which committee has been constituted by the Government of India to boost cashless transaction?

(a) Nachiket Mor Committee
(b) Shanta Kumar Committee
(c) H.R. Khan Committee
(d) Neeraj Kumar Gupta Committee
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

The Neeraj Kumar Gupta Committee was constituted in April, 2016 by the Government of India and the RBI to boost cashless transactions and reduce cash transactions in the economy. After the demonetization in November, 2016 the Government of India formed a new committee, headed by NITI Aayog CEO Amitabh Kant, to form a strategy to expedite the process of transforming India into a cashless economy.

3. As per the new methodology, the lending rate is calculated by the banks based on

(a) average cost of funds
(b) repo rate

(c) marginal cost of funds
(d) inflation rate
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

The lending rate is calculated by the banks based on the Marginal cost of funds. These funds increase in financial cost for a lending institution as a result of adding one more dollar of new funding is known as the marginal cost of fund. It is the incremental cost or differentiated cost and is considered important for making decision on the capital structure.

4. The Eighth Five Year Plan gives priority to-

(a) To increase employment
(b) On increasing imports
(c) To increase industry
(d) Freedom of the press

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

The Eighth Five Year Plan for the period 1992-97 was based on the 'John W. Muller' model leading to a liberalized economy. In this plan 'Human Resource Development' was the basic objective and priority was given to increase employment.

5. Who prepared the outline of the second five year plan?

(a) V.N. Gadgil (b) V.K.R.V. Rao
(c) P.C. Mahalanobis (d) C.N. lawyer

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

The then Director General of the Indian Statistical Organization, Prof. P.C. Mahalanobis prepared the outline of the second five year plan.

6. Consider the following Consumer Price Index :

I. Consumer Price Index for Industrial Workers.
II. Consumer Price Index for Agricultural Labourers.
III. Consumer Price Index for Rural Workers.
IV. Consumer Price Index for Urban Non-Manual Employees.

In the given indexes, which is/are compiled by Central Statistics Office (CSO)?

(a) Only III and IV (b) Only I, II and III
(c) Only IV (d) I, II, III and IV

56th to 59th B. P. S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (*)

CPI for Industrial Workers (CPI-IW), CPI for Agricultural Labourers (CPI-AL) and CPI for Rural Labourers (CPI-RL) indexes are compiled by Labour Bureau in the Ministry of Labour and Employment. While CPI for Urban Non-Manual Employees (CPI-UNME) was earlier computed by CSO, which was discontinued since April, 2008. The CPI-Urban and CPI-Rural (and CPI-Combined) Indexes are compiled by the National Statistical Office (NSO) in the Ministry of Statistics and Programme implementation.

7. The Reserve Bank of India is using which of the following inflation indices as anchor for 'Inflation Targeting'?

(a) WPI (b) GDP deflator
(c) CPI - combined (d) CPI - industrial workers
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

Reserve Bank of India (RBI) uses inflation targeting as a tool to decide Monetary Policy rates, Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) of the RBI uses CPI data to control Inflation. CPI combined is a detailed measure used for the estimation of price changes in a basket of goods and services representative of consumption expenditure in an economy. CPI is released by National Statistical Organisation (NSO) Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation.

8. Which of the following is not directly important for economic development?

(a) Quantity of money (b) Price stability
(c) Savings rate (d) Resource utilization

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

Money is used as a medium of exchange, which helps in the smooth functioning of economic activities. i.e. it does not contribute directly but indirectly to economic development like price stability, savings rate and utilization of resources.

9. The base year for All-India Wholesale Price Index (WPI) has been changed by the Government of India from 2004-05 to :

(a) 2010-11 (b) 2011-12
(c) 2012-13 (d) 2013-14
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

As per the question period, the new Wholesale Price Index (WPI) series was introduced on 14 September, 2010. The base year of this WPI series was 2004-05. On 12 May, 2017 (effective from April, 2017) the base year of the WPI revised from 2004-05 to 2011-12.

10. Which of the following commercial banks of India comes in top 100 global banks?

(a) ICICI Bank (b) SBI
(c) HDFC Bank (d) Kotak Mahindra Bank
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

As per the report released by S & P Global Market Intelligence in April 2020, India had only one bank in the top 100 global bank list (by total assets). State Bank of India (SBI) at 55th position is the only Indian Bank in this list. China has 18 banks while the U.S. has 12 in the list. In April 2021 list, SBI's rank was 57th among World's 100 largest banks. In April 2022, SBI ranked at 53rd among the world's 100 largest banks. SBI is ranked at 48th place in the World's 100 largest banks list, 2023, released by S & P Global Market Intelligence. According to S & P Global Market Intelligence Report, 2024 the rank of SBI is 20, HDFC Bank 33 and ICICI Bank 48. These three banks are included in top 50 banks of the Asia-Pacific region.

11. Which is the highest bank in the banking system of India?

(a) State Bank of India
(b) Reserve Bank of India
(c) Central Bank of India
(d) Industrial Development Bank of India

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is the apex bank in India's banking system as the banker to the government and the banker to the banks and the lender of last resort. The Reserve Bank of India is responsible for issuing notes and formulation and implementation of monetary policy. It was established on 1st April, 1935 under the provision of Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934 and nationalized in the year 1949.

12. Which of the following organizations provides guarantee to exporters in India?

(a) RBI
(b) Export Loan Guarantee Corporation
(c) Exim Bank
(d) Commerce Ministry
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (b)

In India, the Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India (ECGC), provides guarantee to exporters. ECGS offers various export Credit insurance schemes to protect exporters against risks such as non-payment by buyers, political risks, and commercial risks associated with exporting goods and services.

13. From time to time, which among the following publishes the 'exchange control manual' in context with the foreign exchange in India?

(a) SEBI (b) Department of Commerce
(c) RBI (d) Foreign Promotion Board
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (c)

The 'Exchange Control manual' published by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) serves as a comprehensive guide outlining the regulations, policies, and procedures governing foreign exchange transaction, in India. It provides detailed information on various aspects related to foreign exchange management.

14. Which private sector bank has launched 'e-Kisaan Dhan' app for farmers?

(a) Axis Bank (b) HDFC Bank
(c) IDBI Bank (d) Kotak Mahindra Bank
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

Private sector HDFC Bank launched the **'e-Kisaan Dhan'** app for farmers all over India in June, 2020. Through this app the farmers will be able to access a bouquet of services, both banking and agriculture, through their mobile phones. 'e-Kisaan Dhan' app will provide value-added services like mandi prices, latest farming news, weather forecast, information on seed varieties and more. Users can also avail multiple banking services through this app.

15. 'Gullak Bachcha Bank' is a bank based in :

(a) Delhi (b) Patna
(c) Bhopal (d) Jaipur
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

'Gullak Bachcha Bank' is a bank managed entirely by the children at the Bal Bhavan-Kilkari in Patna. Opened on Children's Day, November, 14, 2009 by Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar, it was an experiment in thrift education. This bank has four objectives – help children understand the importance and correct use of money; develop the habit of saving; promote understanding of the banking system; and encourage the spirit of mutual cooperation.

16. In Indian currency, the one rupee note is issued under the signature of :

(a) Governor of Reserve Bank of India

(b) President of India

(c) Finance Secretary, Ministry of Finance, Govt. of India

(d) Finance Minister, Govt. of India

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

The Reserve Bank of India does not issue one rupee notes and coins, while other notes of different denominations are issued by the RBI. One rupee note was issued by the Government of India bearing the signature of the Finance Secretary while other notes bear the signature of RBI Governor. Currently, Tuhin Kanta Pandey is Finance Secretary of India.

17. Financial sector reforms in India consist of :

(a) Lowering down of CRR and SLR

(b) Entry of private firms in insurance sector

(c) Deregulation of interest rates

(d) All of the above

56th to 59th B. P. S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

The financial sector reforms refer to steps taken by the Government to reform the banking system, capital market, government debt market, foreign exchange market etc. The financial sector reforms in India mainly consist of :

- Lowering down of CRR and SLR
- Deregulation of deposit and lending interest rates
- Entry of private firms in banking and insurance sector
- Reforms related to non-performing assets (NPA)
- Elimination of direct or selective credit controls.

Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

18. Which of the following is not a quantitative method of credit control?

(a) Bank Rate Policy (b) Margin Requirements

(c) Open Market Operation (d) CRR

(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Project Manager Prelims 2021

Ans. (b)

Quantitative Credit Controls are used to maintain proper quantity of credit, and money supply in market. Some of the important general credit control methods are–

- Bank Rate Policy
- Open Market Operations
- Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)
- Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR)
- Repo Rates & Reverse Repo Rate

19. Indian currency is printed on-

(a) Reserve Bank of India (b) Ministry of Finance

(c) in the Parliament (d) Nashik Printing Press

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

Currency Press Note, Nashik (Maharashtra) prints and supplies 10, 20, 50, 100, 200, 500 and 2000 rupee notes. Indian currency is also printed at the Bank Note Press, Dewas (Madhya Pradesh) and Shahbani (West Bengal) and the Indian Reserve Bank Note Mudran Limited at Mysore (Karnataka) in addition to the Currency Press Note.

20. Note Issue system in India is based on-

(a) Proportional Fund System

(b) on minimum Reserve system

(c) on fixed exchange system

(d) on full variability system

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

The Minimum Reserve System (MRS) is the currency issue system followed by the RBI at present. It was adopted in 1956. The MRS which requires the RBI to keep a minimum reserve of Rs. 200 Crores comprising foreign currencies, gold coin and gold bullion (Min. of Rs. 115 Crore in the form of gold).

21. Lowering the Cash Reserve Ratio, it will have the following impact on the economy:

I. Banks will have higher leverage to liquidity.

II. The economy may see increased investment.

III. Supply of currency in the economy may broaden.

IV. Real investment rate may decline.

Select the correct code :

(a) I only (b) Both I and II

(c) I, II, III and IV (d) II, III and IV

(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2020

Ans. (e)

Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR) is described as a particular percentage of cash deposits that must be maintained by every bank in India as per the requirements of the RBI. If RBI lowers the CRR, the banks will have higher leverage to liquidity because it increases the loanable funds with the bank. The banks in turn can sanction further loans to businesses and industry for different investment purposes and the economy may see increased investment. It also increases the overall supply of money in the economy. Hence, Statement I, II and III are correct while statement IV is incorrect.

22. If the Cash Reserve Ratio is lowered by the RBI, it's impact on credit creation will be :

(a) Increase (b) Decrease

(c) No impact (d) None of the above

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

23. Consider the following statements :

1. Bank Rate is the rate of interest which RBI charges its clients on their short-term borrowing.

2. Repo Rate is the rate of interest which RBI charges its clients on their long-term borrowing.

Which of the statements given above is / are incorrect?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Bank Rate is the rate at which the Reserve Bank is ready to buy or rediscount bills of exchange or other commercial papers. In general terms, a bank rate is the interest rate at which nation's central bank (RBI) lends money to commercial banks for long term financial requirements. Hence statement (1) is incorrect. Under Repo Rate, RBI lends money to commercial banks for a short term. Hence statement (2) is also incorrect. Hence, the option (c) is the correct answer. Currently, the rapo rate is 6.50% (October, 2024).

24. Bank rate means :

(a) Interest rate charge by moneylenders

(b) Interest rate charged by Scheduled Banks

(c) Rate of profit of banking institution

(d) Official rate of interest charged by Central Bank

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th and 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

Bank Rate implies the rate of interest at which the RBI discounts the Bills of Exchange. In other words, it is the rate of interest at which RBI provides loans to the commercial banks. It is an instrument of monetary policy to influence money supply in the economy. At present the Bank rate is 6.75% (October 2024).

25. The main source of the revenue of the Government of India is-

(a) direct tax

(b) indirect tax

(c) deficit replacement

(d) borrowing from the Reserve Bank of India

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992-93

Ans. (b)

Option (b) was the correct answer in the question period, while according to the budget estimate for 2022-23, the main source of revenue in the year 2022-23 is direct tax. Direct and indirect taxes are 5.5% and 5.2% of GDP respectively in the year 2022-23. As per budget 2024-25, this main source of revenue in the year 2024-25 is direct tax. Direct tax contribute around 55% in total tax revenue of government.

26. At present, who is the Governor of the Reserve Bank of India?

(a) Urjit Patel

(b) Raghuram Rajan

(c) Shanta Kumar

(d) Lalita D. Gupta

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (e)

Shaktikanta Das, former Secretary, Department of Revenue and Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Government of India assumed charge as the 25th Governor of the Reserve Bank of India w.e.f. 12 December, 2018. Before him, Dr. Urjit Patel was the Governor of the RBI from 4 September, 2016 to 11 December, 2018 and Dr. Raghuram Rajan was Governor of the RBI from 4 September, 2013 to 4 September, 2016.

27. R.N. Malhotra committee is related to-

(a) sick industries

(b) tax reforms

(c) insurance sector

(d) banking sector

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

As per the major recommendation of the Malhotra Committee Report (January 7, 1994), the IRDA Act, 1999 was passed. The report recommended setting up of an independent regulatory authority for the insurance sector. IRDA came into existence as a statutory body in April, 2000. The objective of IRDA is to protect the interests of the policyholders, orderly regulation, promotion of the insurance industry and to deal with related and incidental matters.

28. On October 8, 1991, the Reserve Bank of India increased the bank rate from 11% to -

(a) 11.5% per annum (b) 12.0% per annum

(c) 12.5% per annum (d) 13.0% per annum

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

Option (b) was the correct answer in the question period. The current policy rates is as follows (as on August 05, 2023), Bank Rate 6.75%, MSF Rate – 6.75%, Repo Rate 6.50%, Standing Deposit Facility Rate 6.25%, Fixed Reverse Repo Rate 3.35%, Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR) 4.50% and Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR) is 18%. As per current data, the bank rate is 6.75% (as on October, 2024).

29. In general, the main objective of monetary policy is-

(a) Control money supply

(b) Control private banks

(c) Control stock market

(d) Control precious metals market

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

According to Harry J. Johnson, "Monetary policy refers to the control policy by which the central bank exercises control over the supply of money for the purpose of achieving the goals of general economic policy." But in a developing country like India, through its monetary policy, where the central bank regulates the amount of credit (control of money supply) on the one hand, on the other hand it fulfills the requirements of money and credit generated by development programs.

30. Who amongst the following is the present Governor of the RBI?

(a) Bimal Jalan

(b) Arvind Subramanian

(c) Raghuram Rajan

(d) Urjit Patel

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

During the question period, the Governor of the RBI was Urjit Patel who served as the 24th Governor from 4 September, 2016 to 11 December, 2018. The present Governor of the RBI is Shaktikanta Das who is the 25th Governor from 12 December, 2018.

31. Match the column-A with the column-B and select the correct answer using the codes given below :

Column -A	Column -B
A. 1955	1. Export-Import Bank of India
B. 1964	2. Industrial Development Bank of India
C. 1982	3. Industrial Credit and Investment Corporation of India
D. 1987	4. Board of Industrial and Financial Reconstruction

Codes :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	2	3	1	4
(c)	3	2	1	4
(d)	4	1	2	3

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Export-Import Bank of India was set up in March 1982 through Exim Bank Act, 1981. It provides financial assistance to exporters and importers with a view to promoting the country's international trade. IDBI was constituted under Industrial Development Bank of India Act, 1964 as a Development Financial Institution (DFI) and came into being on July 01, 1964. ICICI was formed in 1955 to provide medium-term and long-term project financing to Indian businesses and BIFR was set up in January 1987.

32. When was the Life Insurance Corporation of India established?

(a) 1956 (b) 1944

(c) 1950 (d) 1947

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

Institution		Established in (Year)
Life Insurance Corporation of India (L.I.C.)	–	1956
Unit Trust of India (U.T.I.)	–	1963
Industrial Development Bank of India (IDBI)	–	July 1964
Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)	–	1992

33. The Reserve Bank of India has decided to invest money to help in India's foreign trade-

(a) Through NABARD (b) Through Exim Bank

(c) IDBI through (d) By State Bank of India

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997-98

Ans. (b)

The Export-Import Bank of India, which was established on January 1, 1982, aims to provide financial facilities to exporters and importers, as well as to commercial banks and financial institutions. Also provides refinance facilities against their export-import financing activities. Exim Bank can borrow from the Reserve Bank of India to meet its financial requirements.

34. NABARD (National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development) is aimed at

(a) rural credit (b) industrial credit

(c) urban credit (d) All of the above

(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (a)

NABARD, which stands for National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development is aimed at fostering rural development by providing financial and development support to agriculture and rural sectors in India. It serves as an apex institution in the field of rural credit, with a mandate to promote sustainable and equitable agriculture and rural prosperity through credit, development, and other support services. NABARD was established on 12 July 1982.

35. Which one of the following is not a source of direct finance?

(a) NABARD (b) Regional Rural Bank

(c) State Bank of India (d) Allahabad Bank

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (e)

All of the above given institutions are sources of direct finance. NABARD does not provide direct finance to individuals, but it provides direct finance to food parks, warehouses, cold chains and storages, marketing federations etc. while RRBs, SBI and Allahabad Bank provide direct finance to individuals as well as industries and other sectors.

36. Life Insurance Corporation is an example of-

(a) Commercial bank (b) Development bank

(c) Investment bank (d) Co-operative bank

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

Life Insurance Corporation (LIC) invests in industrial securities by mobilizing the savings of the general public. Thus, LIC is an example of investment bank. LIC collects huge amounts of money on the basis of insurance from the general public and invests them in other sectors of the economy and receives huge returns from such investments.

37. Regional Rural Banks, also known as Gramin Banks, are classified as-

(a) In the form of land development banks

(b) In the form of branches of commercial banks

(c) from unscheduled banks

(d) Scheduled commercial banks

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

With a view to improve the financial condition of Regional Rural Banks (RRBs), efforts have been made in the last few years to change their working area. Provided this facility to RRBs that where earlier it was mandatory for them to lend only to priority sectors, now they can lend to these sectors only up to 40%.

38. NABARD lends to-

(a) To the individual of agriculture

(b) The institutions of rural development

(c) Banks for agriculture and rural development

(d) State governments for agriculture

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

NABARD, established on 12 July 1982, is the apex institution for providing refinance for agriculture and rural development. NABARD does not provide direct finance for agriculture and rural development and provides loans to banks for agriculture and rural development established for this purpose.

39. During which Plan Period was the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD) established?

(a) Third Five Year Plan (b) Fifth Five Year Plan

(c) Sixth Five Year Plan (d) Eighth Five Year Plan

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

NABARD (National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development) was established during the Sixth Five Year Plan on 12 July 1982. Its headquarters is located in Mumbai. It is the apex institution for providing agricultural refinance in India. NABARD promotes sustainable and equitable agriculture